

CUET-PG ENGLISH (LAQP01)

High-Yield PYQ Revision Booklet & Personal Study Guide

Target Examination: CUET-PG MA English (Paper Code: LAQP01)

Total Questions: 75 Domain MCQs | **Marks:** 300 (+4 correct, -1 wrong)

Target Score: 220+ / 300 (Top Central Universities: JNU, DU, EFLU, BHU, UoH)

Purpose: Handcrafted revision notes for self-study. Contains all repeated concepts, match tables, and verified previous-year facts.

How to Use This Booklet (For Self-Study)

- **Read with a Highlighter:** Keep a pen or highlighter and mark items as you memorize them.
- **Focus on Tables First:** 35% of the exam questions are Match-the-Following. The tables in Section 2 will give you immediate, easy marks.
- **Alternate Day Revision:** Read the 50 High-Frequency Facts (Section 4) once in the morning and once before bed.

30-Day Step-by-Step Study Roadmap

Phase	Days	Topics to Cover	Daily Goal
Phase 1	Days 1–7	Literary Terms & Critical Concepts (Abrams Glossary top 40)	Memorize 6 terms + 3 critics daily
Phase 2	Days 8–14	Indian Writing in English (Big 3 Novelists, 4 Major Poets, Karnad)	Read plot summaries & award years
Phase 3	Days 15–22	Major British Literature (Chaucer, Shakespeare, Milton, Romantics)	Memorize chronology & text matches
Phase 4	Days 23–30	Solve Real PYQs (2022 to 2026 papers) under 90-min timer	1 full paper every 2 days + Error Log

Section 2: Master 'Match-the-Following' Tables (35% Weightage)

NTA tests these pairings repeatedly. Memorize these exact combinations:

Theorist / Critic	Key Critical Term / Coinage	Essential Context / Essay
T.S. Eliot	Objective Correlative	'Hamlet and His Problems' (1919)
T.S. Eliot	Dissociation of Sensibility	'The Metaphysical Poets' (1921)
John Keats	Negative Capability	1817 Letter to brothers (Exemplar: Shakespeare)
S.T. Coleridge	Primary vs. Secondary Imagination	<i>Biographia Literaria</i> (1817, Ch. 13)
Aristotle	Hamartia & Catharsis	<i>Poetics</i> (Tragic error / Purgation of pity)
W.K. Wimsatt & M. Beardsley	Intentional & Affective Fallacy	<i>The Verbal Icon</i> (1954, New Criticism)
Viktor Shklovsky	Defamiliarization (Ostranenie)	'Art as Technique' (1917, Russian Formalism)
Roland Barthes	The Death of the Author	1967 Essay (Birth of reader = Death of author)
Jacques Derrida	Différance & Deconstruction	<i>Of Grammatology</i> (1967)
Michel Foucault	Panopticon & Discourse	<i>Discipline and Punish</i> (1975, Surveillance)
Edward Said	Orientalism	1978 Book (West's construct of the Orient)
Homi Bhabha	Mimicry, Hybridity, Third Space	<i>The Location of Culture</i> (1994)
Gayatri Spivak	Subalternity & Strategic Essentialism	'Can the Subaltern Speak?' (1988)
Elaine Showalter	Gynocriticism	3 Phases: Feminine, Feminist, Female
Ferdinand de Saussure	Langue/Parole, Signifier/Signified	<i>Course in General Linguistics</i> (1916)

Core Literary Terms & Figures of Speech

Literary Term	Exact Definition / Characteristic	Famous Example
Dramatic Monologue	Single speaker talking to a silent listener at a moment of crisis	Robert Browning: 'My Last Duchess'
Soliloquy	Character speaks private thoughts aloud while alone on stage	Shakespeare: Hamlet's 'To be or not to be'
Oxymoron	Two contradictory terms conjoined side-by-side	'Deafening silence', 'Cruel kindness'
Paradox	Seemingly contradictory statement revealing deeper truth	Wordsworth: 'The Child is father of the Man'
Metonymy	Substituting the name of an object with an associated attribute	'The Crown' for the King/Monarchy
Synecdoche	Part is made to represent the whole	'All hands on deck' (hands = sailors)
Bildungsroman	Novel of personal moral and psychological formation from youth	Dickens: <i>David Copperfield</i> ; Bronte: <i>Jane Eyre</i>
Blank Verse	Unrhymed iambic pentameter (10 syllables, unstressed/stressed)	Milton: <i>Paradise Lost</i> ; Shakespeare plays

Section 3: Indian Writing in English & Chronology Rules

Indian Writing in English contributes ****16%–18% of the total paper**** and offers the highest return on study time because questions are direct and factual.

Author	Key Works Tested in PYQs	Essential Facts to Memorize
Mulk Raj Anand	<i>Untouchable</i> (1935), <i>Coolie</i> (1936)	Protagonist Bakha; covers a single day in Bulashah; Preface by E.M. Forster
Raja Rao	<i>Kanthapura</i> (1938), <i>Serpent and the Rope</i>	Narrated by old grandmother Achakka; Harikatha/Sthala-Purana oral mode; leader Moorthy
R.K. Narayan	<i>Swami and Friends</i> (1935), <i>The Guide</i> (1958)	Fictional town Malgudi; Raju the guide, Rosie; won 1960 Sahitya Akademi Award
Nissim Ezekiel	'Night of the Scorpion', 'Miss Pushpa T.S.'	Mother stung by scorpion, villager superstitions vs father's rationalism
Kamala Das	'An Introduction', <i>My Story</i> (1976)	'I am Indian, very brown, born in Malabar...'; Confessional poet
A.K. Ramanujan	'A River', 'Obituary', 'Small-Scale Reflections'	Madurai river drying up; poems dealing with South Indian familial memory
Girish Karnad	<i>Tughlaq</i> (1964), <i>Hayavadana</i> (1971)	Muhammad bin Tughlaq shifts capital to Daulatabad; Hayavadana uses Thomas Mann theme

Chronological Ordering Formulas (Must Memorize)

1. English Literary Ages in Order:

Old English (450–1066) → Middle English (1066–1500) → Elizabethan (1558–1603) → Jacobean (1603–1625) → Restoration (1660–1700) → Augustan/Neoclassical (1700–1745) → Romantic (1798–1837) → Victorian (1837–1901) → Modern (1901–1945) → Postmodern (1945 onwards).

2. Shakespeare's Four Great Tragedies:

Remember the mnemonic **H - O - L - M**:

Hamlet (1601) → **O**thello (1603) → King **L**ear (1605) → **M**acbeth (1606).

3. Modern Drama Sequence:

Samuel Beckett's *Waiting for Godot* (1953) → Harold Pinter's *The Birthday Party* (1957) → Caryl Churchill's *Cloud Nine* (1979).

Section 4: Top 30 High-Frequency Revision Bullets

Read these 30 points repeatedly. Each point represents an actual repeated question:

1. **Shakespeare's Sonnets:** 154 sonnets in total (1–126 to Fair Youth / Mr. W.H., 127–152 to Dark Lady, 153–154 to Cupid). Rhyme scheme: *ABAB CDCD EFEF GG*.
2. **First Folio:** Published in **1623** by Shakespeare's fellow actors John Heminge and Henry Condell (contained 36 plays; omitted *Pericles*).
3. **Milton's Paradise Lost:** Published in 10 books in 1667, redivided into 12 books in 1674. Written in heroic blank verse.
4. **Milton's Areopagitica (1644):** Landmark prose polemic defending freedom of the press and protesting government licensing/censorship.
5. **Lyrical Ballads (1798):** Jointly published by Wordsworth and Coleridge (23 poems: 19 by Wordsworth, 4 by Coleridge). Opens with *The Rime of the Ancient Mariner* and closes with *Tintern Abbey*. Preface added in 1800.
6. **Poetry Definition:** Wordsworth defined poetry in Preface (1800) as 'the spontaneous overflow of powerful feelings recollected in tranquility'.
7. **Chaucer's Canterbury Tales:** Written in Middle English; 29 pilgrims meet at the Tabard Inn in Southwark for a pilgrimage to the shrine of Thomas Becket in Canterbury.
8. **Alexander Pope's Rape of the Lock:** Mock-heroic epic in heroic couplets based on Lord Petre snipping a lock of Arabella Fermor's (Belinda's) hair. Guardian sylph: Ariel.
9. **John Dryden's An Essay on Dramatic Poesy (1668):** Dialogue between 4 gentlemen: Eugenius (defends moderns), Crites (defends ancients), Lisideius (defends French plays), and Neander (Dryden himself, defends English drama and Shakespeare).
10. **Jonathan Swift's Gulliver's Travels (1726):** Four voyages: 1. Lilliput (tiny people), 2. Brobdingnag (giants), 3. Laputa (impractical scientists), 4. Houyhnhnms (rational horses vs. savage Yahoos).
11. **Charles Dickens's Autobiographical Novel:** *David Copperfield* (1850) is Dickens's most autobiographical novel ('the favourite child').
12. **George Eliot:** Pen name of Mary Ann Evans; wrote *Middlemarch* (subtitled 'A Study of Provincial Life', protagonist: Dorothea Brooke).
13. **Thomas Hardy's Wessex:** Set novels in fictional region of Wessex; subtitle of *Tess of the d'Urbervilles* is 'A Pure Woman Faithfully Presented'.
14. **Virginia Woolf's Judith Shakespeare:** In *A Room of One's Own* (1929), Woolf invents Shakespeare's equally gifted fictional sister Judith who commits suicide due to lack of opportunity.
15. **James Joyce's Ulysses:** Captures a single day (16 June 1904, known as Bloomsday) in Dublin. Main characters: Leopold Bloom, Molly Bloom, Stephen Dedalus.
16. **T.S. Eliot's The Waste Land (1922):** 434 lines divided into 5 sections: 1. The Burial of the Dead, 2. A Game of Chess, 3. The Fire Sermon, 4. Death by Water, 5. What the Thunder Said. Ends with 'Shantih shantih shantih'. Dedicated to Ezra Pound ('il miglior fabbro').
17. **Theatre of the Absurd:** Term coined by Martin Esslin; includes Samuel Beckett (*Waiting for Godot*), Eugene Ionesco (*The Bald Soprano*), Harold Pinter (*The Birthday Party*).
18. **Chinua Achebe's Things Fall Apart (1958):** Protagonist is Okonkwo in Umuofia village; title taken from W.B. Yeats's poem 'The Second Coming'.

19. **Wole Soyinka:** First African writer awarded the Nobel Prize in Literature (1986); wrote *A Dance of the Forests* and *Death and the King's Horseman*.
20. **Mary Wollstonecraft:** *A Vindication of the Rights of Woman* (1792) is a foundational feminist text advocating education for women.
21. **John Stuart Mill:** *The Subjection of Women* (1869) argued for perfect equality between the sexes.
22. **Simone de Beauvoir:** *The Second Sex* (1949) famously declared: 'One is not born, but rather becomes, a woman.'
23. **Eugene Nida:** Translation theorist who coined 'Formal Equivalence' (word-for-word accuracy) vs. 'Dynamic Equivalence' (sense-for-sense naturalness).
24. **Lawrence Venuti:** Formulated 'Domestication' (assimilating foreign text to target culture) vs. 'Foreignization' (preserving source text's cultural difference).
25. **Mikhail Bakhtin:** Russian theorist who introduced *Carnavalesque* (subversion of authority), *Heteroglossia* (diversity of voices/languages), and *Dialogism*.
26. **Walter Benjamin:** 'The Work of Art in the Age of Mechanical Reproduction' (1935) argues that technological reproduction destroys an artwork's unique 'Aura'.
27. **Harold Bloom:** *The Anxiety of Influence* (1973) formulates the Oedipal struggle of poet against precursor poet; first revisionary ratio is *Clinamen* (poetic misprision).
28. **First Indian English Novel:** Bankim Chandra Chatterjee's *Rajmohan's Wife* (1864).
29. **Toru Dutt:** Early Indian English poetess who wrote 'Our Casuarina Tree' and *Ancient Ballads and Legends of Hindustan*.
30. **Sahitya Akademi First English Winner:** R.K. Narayan in 1960 for his novel *The Guide*.